

9 Using Commands

[Tab] and the Terminal will finish the directory name Users for you. Here are some tips for tab completion:

- Tab Completion is case-sensitive.
- Terminal adds backslashes automatically, if your directory names include spaces, \$ signs, or other special characters. But you still have to insert your own backslashes when you type the initial characters that tip off tab completion.
- If it can't find a match for what you typed, Terminal will produce an error tone indicating the path does not exist. If it finds more than one file or directory that match what you typed, Terminal beeps and shows you a list of them. To specify the one which you really wanted, type the next letter and then press [Tab] again.

9.1.7 Using the history

Retyping any command, is never necessary. Terminal (or, rather, the `tcsh` shell it's running) remembers the last 150 commands that you entered. At any prompt, instead of typing, just press the up or down arrow keys to scroll through the various commands in the shell's memory.

Note

To see a list of what's in a directory and in all the directories inside it, just type `ls *`.

9.1.8 Wildcards

Wildcards are special characters that represent other characters in Unix. For example, to see a list of the files in the working directory that end with the letters at, you could type `ls *at`. Terminal would show you files named borat, wildcat, lolcat, and so on; and hide all other files in the list. Likewise, to see which files and directories begin with Im, you could type `ls Im*` and press [Enter]. You'd be shown only the names of icons in the working directory called Image01, Image02, Impotent, and so on.

9.1.9 The ~ shortcut

The ~ is a shortcut to your home directory. You can also use it as a shortcut to somebody else's home directory simply by tacking on that person's Mac OS X account name. For example, to change to Ram's home directory, use `cd ~Ram`.

9.2 Working with Files and Directories

This section shows you how to copy, move, create, and delete directories and files you have navigated to and listed.